

Manaslu Circuit Trek - 12 Days

URL: <https://nepalalternativetreks.com/trip/manaslu-circuit-trek/>

Duration 12	Per Person Cost USD 830	Difficulty Moderate
Weather -10°C to 20°C	Accommodation Lodges	Meals Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner
Religion Buddhism	Transportation Bus/Jeep	Max Altitude 5106m./16849ft.
Region of Nepal Manaslu Region, Gorkha	Ethnic People Gurung, Tibetan, Magar	Daily Activity Approx. 5 – 6 hours
Best Seasons Sept, Oct, Nov, March, April, May	Geographic Terrain Mountain, Forest, Village, Lakes, Rivers, Terrace	

Manaslu Circuit Trek Highlights

- Hike to the Manaslu Base Camp, which has the 8th highest peak in the world, Manaslu Base Camp.
- Trek to one of the least crowded trails of Nepal.
- Witness the breathtaking views of the Mansiri Himal and its surrounding peaks.
- Trek through the Budhi Gandaki Gorge.
- Experience the perfect blend of Hindu and Buddhist culture.
- Reach the Tibetan border of Samdo Village.
- Encounter different Flora and Fauna of the Himalayan region.
- Taste the authentic Nepali cuisine such as Daal Bhaat, Thukpa, Dhindo, etc.

Weather

January -10°C to 5°C	February -8°C to 6°C	March -5°C to 10°C
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April	May	June
0°C to 15°C	5°C to 18°C	7°C to 20°C
July	August	September
8°C to 20°C	8°C to 20°C	5°C to 18°C
October	November	December
0°C to 15°C	-5°C to 10°C	-8°C to 5°C

Trip Overview

Manaslu Circuit Trek Overview

12 Days Manaslu Circuit Trek is an uncommon, off-the-beaten-track trekking destination in Nepal. It offers stunning and majestic views of the mountains and the chance for cultural immersion. This trek takes you close to Mount Manaslu, which is at an altitude of 5100m. Mt Manaslu is the highest mountain in the world at 8163m. Besides Mount Manaslu, you will also see other mountain peaks, like Annapurna, Hiunchuli, Buddha, and Ganesh Himal. Manaslu Circuit Trek is famous because it is easily accessible from Kathmandu's capital. You will reach your destination within an 8-10 hour drive from Kathmandu.

One major attraction to explore during your Manaslu Circuit Trek is the Manaslu Conservation Area. You can stroll around the amazing Manaslu Conservation Area, where you can find all the rare and endangered species of plants and animals. The area has 110 species of birds, 33 mammals, 3 reptiles, and 11 butterflies. There are a few more amazing places of attraction that you can explore during your trek. You can visit Rupina La Pass, Larkya La Pass, Birendra Lake, and others. Hence, Trekking Manaslu Circuit is a once-in-a-lifetime opportunity. If you are only familiar with more commercialized treks like Everest or Annapurna Base Camp Trek, then we recommend you try Manaslu Circuit Trek at least once.

Where is Mt. Manaslu Located?

Mt. Manaslu is 8163m above sea level and is located in the western central part of Nepal, in the Mansiri part of the Nepalese Himalayas. The name Manaslu comes from the word "mountain of the spirit." It is situated on Mount Annapurna's eastern side and about 64km apart.

Mount Manaslu is the highest peak in the Gorkha district. The stunning peaks and valleys tower around the region, making the surrounding valley look majestic when you climb the ridge leading towards the peak.

Mount Manaslu was first climbed by dual mountain climbers Gyalzen Norbu and Toshio Imanishi on May 9, 1956. At that time, they were part of an exceptional, highly professional Japanese expedition team. Many historians have claimed that Janpaese mountain climbers love climbing Mount Manaslu even more

than British people who love climbing Mount Everest.

Can Beginner Trek to Manaslu Circuit?

Yes, beginners can trek the Manaslu Circuit. You don't need trekking experience or training to climb mountains.

However, you shouldn't mistake it for an easy trek. It falls under moderate-level trekking for even veteran trekkers. This means that for beginners, this trek will undoubtedly be quite challenging. Certain factors increase the difficulty level during your trek. These factors affect beginner trekkers more adversely than the expert veterans who have been trekking for days.

The factors are Altitude, Best Time, Acclimatization, Drinking Water, Physical Fitness, etc. Understanding these basic factors before heading for the Manaslu Circuit Trek will make the trek less challenging than going there completely blind.

So, preparing for the Manaslu Circuit Trek by improving your physical fitness and spending time on breathing exercises will make your trek less challenging and more fun. Also, acclimatize as much as you can and listen to your body. Don't forget to take medication for altitude sickness if you are a beginner in case of emergencies.

12 Days Manaslu Circuit Trek Day-to-day-Itinerary

Day 1: Drive to Machha Khola from Kathmandu

Your 12 Days Manaslu Circuit Trek starts with a bus drive along the Prithvi Highway from Kathmandu. The initial drive starts from Kathmandu as you go through the pitched paved road to Dhading Bensi. Then the road turns upward to Gola Bhanjyang and slopes down to Ankhu Khola. At Arughat, you cross the Budhi Gandaki River and drive further to reach Sotikhola. We continue to drive for two hours to reach Machhakhola. This Ten-hour drive rewards you with scenic villages, rivers, terraced farms, and a good view of Mount Manaslu and Ganesh. Overnight in Machhakhola.

Destination:	Accommodation	Altitude:
180km Drive to Machhakhola (Av.10 hours)	Larke Peak Hotel or similar category	(690m./2277ft.)

Meals

Lunch, Dinner

Day 2: Trek to Jagat

The second day of the Manaslu Circuit Trek starts with breakfast. After breakfast, we prepare to trek to Jagat. First, we trek along the Budhi Gandaki River's bank and ascend through Sal's dense forests. The trail then takes us to Tatopani, which houses natural hot water springs. You can take a dip in the springs

if you like. Then, we continue the trek on Budhi Gandaki's banks again to reach Jagat. Overnight in Jagat.

Destination:	Accommodation	Altitude:
22 km trek to Jagat (Av.07 hours)	New Mangolian Cottage or similar category	(1410m./3990ft.)

Meals

Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 3: Trek to Deng

After our permits are approved, we start the trek to Deng. We first trek through the dense tropical forest and continue to trek alongside the Budhi Gandaki River. The trail of this part runs through the forests, which shelter much rare wildlife. We continue to trek through the forests of the Manaslu region and come across many different villages like Bhatti Khola and Philim. We then cross the bamboo forest over Budhi Gandaki to reach Deng. Overnight in Deng.

Destination:	Accommodation	Altitude:
22 km Uphill hike (Av.08 hours)	Windy Valley Guest House or Similar category	(1960m./6430ft.)

Meals

Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 4: Trek to Namrung

From Deng, we cross a suspension bridge and trek through the uneven trails. The trail leads us to Bihi Phedi. We continue from there to reach Ghap. The trail from Ghap is dangerous as it is prone to dry landslides. After crossing the landslide zone, we go past several Magar villages to reach Namrung. Overnight in Namrung

Destination:	Accommodation	Altitude:
12km Uphill hike (Av.05 hours)	Namrung Guest House or similar category	(2660m./7527ft.)

Meals

Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 5: Trek to Lho Gaon

As we gain altitude, we also start seeing a change in the vegetation and culture. We slowly enter the Tibetan cultured areas as we trek from Namrung. The trail takes us through the Mani walls and stone

houses. On the way, we can also see the beautiful view of mountains like Mt Manaslu (8163m). After trekking for 4 hours, we finally reached Lho. Overnight in Lho.

Destination:	Accommodation	Altitude:
12 km Uphill hike (Av.04 hours)	Majestic Guest House or similar category	(3100m./10230ft.)

Meals

Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 6: Trek to Sama Gaon

After breakfast in Lho, we start our day with a trek towards Sama Gaon. We trek through beautiful pine and rhododendron forests. The breathtaking view of Mt. Manaslu (8163m) follows us throughout the trail. The trek was challenging, and we gained altitude today. We trek for about five hours to reach Sama Gaon. Overnight in Sama Gaon.

Destination:	Accommodation	Altitude:
14 km Uphill hike (Av.06 hours)	Manaslu Hotel or similar category	(3530m./9989ft.)

Meals

Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 7: Acclimatization day/ Exploring around

Trekking to a higher altitude may become dangerous if you do not properly rest. So, we rest for a day today in Sama Gaon. After breakfast, we explore the village and interact with the villagers. We will then hike to Pung Gyan Gompa, enjoying the beautiful view of the Manaslu and other mountains. In the evening, you can interact with the locals and try local foods. You have an option to hike to Manaslu Base Camp and Birendra Lake. Overnight in Sama Gaon.

Destination:	Accommodation	Altitude:
Excursion around	Manaslu Hotel or similar category	(3530m./9989ft.)

Meals

Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 8: Trek to Samdo

We start our trek after a day of rest and breakfast in Sama Gaon. We first trek through the pine forest,

which slowly starts getting sparser. The vegetation disappears, and the land becomes barren. We trek to a remote, isolated part of the trail with the beautiful Mt. Manaslu (8163m) still keeping us company. The trek is about 4 hours along the banks of the reduced Budhi Gandaki River. Overnight in Samdo.

Destination:

12km Uphill hike
(Av.04 hours)

Accommodation

Zambala Guest House or(3780m./12402ft.)
similar category

Altitude:**Meals**

Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 9: Head to Dharmashala

Another day of the 12 days of Manaslu Circuit Trek is here, and today is very important. We trek west along with the views of Naika and Pangbuche peaks. After breakfast in Samdo, we cross a suspension bridge and continue through the uneven, rocky trail. You get a beautiful view of mountains in Manaslu and Himal Chuli range on the route to Dharmashala. After five hours of trekking, we reach Dharmashala. Overnight in Dharmashala.

Destination:

12km Uphill hike
(Av.05 hours)

Accommodation

Larke Peak Guest House or(4200m./13780ft.)
similar category

Altitude:**Meals**

Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 10: Trek to Bimthang

Today, we trek through one of the most challenging and exciting trails of the Manaslu region.. We will trek through the barren and remote part of the Manaslu region. The trek provides us with a beautiful view of Mt. Manaslu (8163m), the eighth-highest mountain in the world. The trail ascends to the top of the Larkya La Pass (5160m) across the rough and snowy trails. From the top, you can relish the views of the Larkya, Mansiri, Cheo, and Himlung Himal ranges. Later, you descend from the pass with a panoramic view of the mountains and glaciers. Overnight in Bimthang.

Destination:

18km Uphill hike
(Av.08 hours)

Accommodation

Punker Cottage House or(4200m./7218ft.)
similar category

Altitude:**Meals**

Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 11: Trek to Dharapani

Today is the last day of our trek as we move towards the end of the Manaslu Circuit Trek adventure. After breakfast in Bimthang, we start our trek towards Dharapani. Today's trek is more comfortable compared to the last few days. We will descend through the pine and rhododendron forests of the Manaslu region. On the way, the beautiful view of the snow-capped mountains follows us. Overnight in Dharapani.

Destination:

16km Uphill hike
(Avg. 7 hours)

Accommodation

Hotel Gurkha's inn or similar(1992m./6535ft.)
category

Altitude:

Meals

Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Day 12: Drive to Besisahar - Drive to Kathmandu

The last day of the Manaslu Circuit Trek is upon us. After breakfast in Dharapani, we embark on a jeep that takes us to Besisahar. The drive to Besisahar is about three hours. We drive through beautiful villages and hills. You get a lovely view of terraced fields and typical Nepali houses on the way. After driving for about 3 hours, we arrive at Besisahar and board the bus to Kathmandu. Driving from Besisahar, we get a splendid view of paddy fields and beautiful settlements. After driving for about an hour, we join the Prithvi Highway and drive alongside the Trishuli River. The drive from here is about four hours. You will be transferred to the hotel in Kathmandu.

Destination:

190km Drive
Kathmandu(Av.10 hours)

Altitude:

to(1290m./4273ft.)

Meals

Breakfast, Lunch

Trip Includes

- Tribhuwan International Airport transfer (Airport - Hotel - Airport) in Kathmandu.
- All meals during the trekking (Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner).
- Lodge accommodation (Twin share basis) will be provided during the trekking.
- One experienced, well-trained, fluent English speaking, friendly, specialized in Manaslu trekking region and government authorized trekking guide and required porters (One porter for two persons)
- Guide and porter's food, accommodation, salary, insurance, transportation, and equipment.
- Overland transport as mentioned in the itinerary.
- Manaslu special permit, ACAP (Annapurna conservation area project), and MCAP (Manaslu conservation area project).
- A trekking map, duffel bag, Oxygen saturation checkup every day, water purification, first aid medical, company t-shirt, and trekking company certificate.

- Assistance for emergency rescue evacuation.
- Government tax and service charge.
- Public Liability Insurance.

What's Not Included

- Hotel accommodation and meals in Kathmandu.
- Hard and soft table drinks such as tea/coffee, coke, fanta, mineral water, beer, hot shower, battery charge, boiled water , phone bill and laundry. .
- Personal Travel insurance.
- Tips for guide and porters. (Highly suggested).

Group Discounts Available

No. of Persons	Price per Person
Group Of 1 - 1	USD \$1,330.00 PP USD \$1,130.00PP
Group Of 2 - 4	USD \$1,030.00 PP USD \$830.00PP
Group Of 5 - 8	USD \$1,010.00 PP USD \$810.00PP
Group Of 9 - 12	USD \$990.00 PP USD \$790.00PP
Group Of 13 - 16	USD \$970.00 PP USD \$770.00PP
Group Of 17 - 20	USD \$950.00 PP USD \$750.00PP
Group Of 21 - 25	USD \$930.00 PP USD \$730.00PP

Route Map

13
Days

Manaslu Trekking Route Map



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TREKKING COMPANY

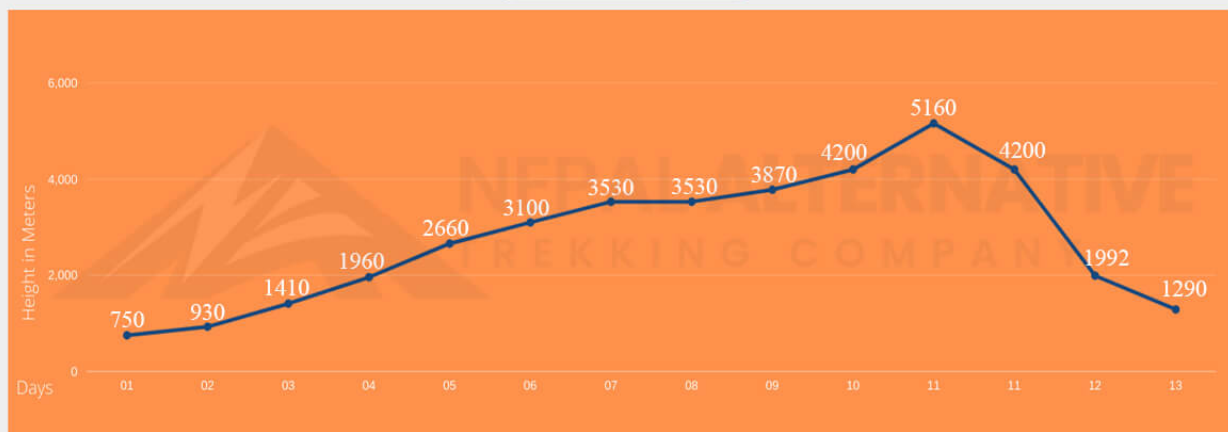
Legend

- Difficulty Level: Strenuous
- Main Hiking Route: ———
- Secondary Route: (dotted)
- View Point:
- Mountain:
- Lake:
- Monastery:
- Pass:



Itinerary Highlight	
Day 01:	Soti Khola
Day 02:	Machhakhola
Day 03:	Jagat
Day 04:	Deng
Day 05:	Namrung
Day 06:	Lho Gaun
Day 07:	Samagaun
Day 08:	Samagaun
Day 09:	Samdo
Day 10:	Dharmasala
Day 11:	Bhimthang
Day 12:	Dharapani
Day 13:	Kathmandu

Altitude Chart



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[Download Route Map](#)

ESSENTIAL INFO

Why Take Manaslu Circuit Trek in 2025?

Manaslu Circuit Trek is one of the spectacular journeys through the restricted area of Nepal. The trek offers jaw-dropping scenery on each turn, providing trekkers with awe. Numerous trekkers explore the Manaslu region yearly for various purposes. Here are some reasons why to take the Manaslu Circuit trek:

Pungyen Gompa

Pungyeb Gompa is a serene and sacred monastery located off the main trail near Samagoan. “Pungyen” translates to “arm bracelet,” symbolizing the strength and solidity of the local community. Situated in a tranquil meadow, the monastery offers spectacular views of Mount Manaslu and its glacier. It is a sacred place for local Buddhists, serving as a central hub for meditation and rituals. Visiting the Gompa adds depth to the trek to Manaslu, allowing one to experience spirituality.

Larkya La Pass

Larkya La Pass, at 5,106m, is the significant highlight of the Manaslu Circuit trek. Yearly, hundreds of trekkers go on adventures to Manaslu to cross the impressive pass at a high elevation. The pass offers an exhilarating climb through rugged terrain that is both challenging and rewarding. From the top of the pass, trekkers can witness a 360-degree vista of Himlung Himal, Choe Himal, and Annapurna II.

Manaslu Conservation Area

The trek to Manaslu Circuit takes place within the protected area of Manaslu Conservation Area. The area covers 1663 sq. km and protects several forests, rivers, lakes, and several species of birds and wildlife. Trekkers who want to see wide variations in the topography and vegetation of the protected area go for the Manaslu Circuit trek. Likewise, the conservation area is a haven for botany aficionados and wildlife enthusiasts.

Off-the-Beaten Trekking Trail

Unlike popular trekking routes like the Annapurna Circuit and Everest Base Camp trek, the Manaslu Circuit remains off-beaten and uncrowded, offering a sense of solitude and tranquility. The off-beaten trail provides a more authentic and immersive experience. Thus, Manaslu Circuit is the best choice for those preferring a refreshing, less-crowded path with a lack of congestion.

Glaciers & Lake

The journey to Manaslu Circuit takes trekkers through massive glaciers and numerous freshwater lakes. Located near Samagaun, the Manaslu glacier is the key glacier trekkers get after a short hike from Samagoan. The glacier originates from Mount Manalasy and offers mesmerizing views of icy walls and massive crevasses. Similarly, Birendra Tal is one of the prominent lakes of the Manaslu region, where trekkers get after a short hike from Samagoan on the acclimatization day. Moreover, the lake lies in Manaslu Glacier and is closer to Punhyen Glacier.

Panoramic Views Of Majestic Snow-capped Mountains

The Manaslu Circuit trek is well-known for its stunning panoramic views of snow-capped peaks. As trekkers pass through diverse landscapes, they'll be treated to astonishing vistas of some of the impressive towering peaks. Key mountain views along the trek include Mount Manaslu, the eighth-highest peak in the world, and the second-highest peak in the Mansiri Himal range, Himalchuli. Likewise, trekkers can glimpse peaks, including the Ganesh Himal range, Shringi Himal, Larkya Peak, and Annapurna II.

Cultural exploration

The trek to Manaslu Circuit offers a unique opportunity to explore the culturally rich communities of Nepal's Himalayas. From ancient monasteries to the warm hospitality of the locals, the trek is more of a cultural exploration than a physical adventure. Each step through the Manaslu region allows trekkers to connect with Tibetan Buddhist tradition.

Required Permits for Manaslu Circuit Trek

Trekking to Manaslu Circuit will require **three permits** in total. **Annapurna Conservation Area Permit(ACAP)**, **Manaslu Conservation Area Permit(MCAP)**, and Manaslu Restricted Area Permit are the three permits required to trek in this region. A **TIMS Card** is mandatory for trekking in Nepal, except for a few treks. However, you do not need a TIMS card for this trek. The cost of a TIMS Card is **NPR 2000**. The other permits required are explained in detail below.

Annapurna Conservation Area Permit

During your trek to Manaslu Circuit Trek, you must pass through the Annapurna Conservation Area from Dharapani until you exit Besi Sahar. Hence, you must issue an Annapurna Conservation Area Permit to complete the Manaslu Circuit Trek.

Cost of ACAP: NPR. **3000** for foreigners and NPR 1000 for **SAARC**

Manaslu Conservation Area Permit

Manaslu Conservation Area starts from the Philim village, which you will explore during this trek. So, you need to issue a Manaslu Conservation Area Permit as well.

Cost of MCAP: NPR 3000 for foreigners and NPR 1000 for **SAARC**

Manaslu Restricted Area Permit

You need a special permit since the Manaslu region is restricted in Nepal. Only a qualified trekking agency can issue your Manaslu Restricted Area permit.

Cost of Manaslu Restricted Permit: USD 100 Sept - Nov for 1 week and USD 15 per day beyond 1 week
: USD 75 Dec-Aug for 1 week and USD 10 per day beyond 1 week

*Note: Children below **10** years are free*

Manaslu Circuit Trek Cost

The Average Manaslu Circuit Trek Cost is **\$830 to \$1030** per person.

If you're looking for an exciting and affordable adventure, trekking in Nepal could be just what you need. Nepal has a range of trekking options to suit your preferences, from easy to moderate to strenuous. Best of all, it's a budget-friendly way to explore Nepal's diverse landscape.

Some treks are expensive, and others are easily accessible and affordable. Manaslu Circuit Trek is affordable, judging by its location, experience, and adventure. There are some of the factors that influence the cost of your Manaslu Circuit Trek, and they are listed below:

- Guides and Porters
- The destination of the trek
- Trekking Activities
- Mode of transportation
- Accommodation
- Length and Duration of Trek
- Cost of Trek Permits and Documents
- Miscellaneous expenses
- Food and Drinks
- Seasons

Factors including the duration of the trek, the chosen trekking agency, the season of travel, and the preferred level of comfort vary the cost for Manaslu Circuit Trek. Similarly, the group size and mode of transportation from Kathmandu to Machhe Khola and Dharapani to Besisahar and back to Kathmandu make changes in the overall cost for Manaslu Circuit Trek. However, on average, the trek costs \$830 to \$1030 per person. The cost covers all the necessary facilities required for the trek, including a guide, accommodations, three times meals a day, required paperwork and permits, and all ground transportation.

However, the cost doesn't cover miscellaneous expenses, including snacks, charging electronic devices, and hot showers. Moreover, Nepal Alternative Treks provides you with a group discount and top-notch service even at a lower price.

How Difficult is Manaslu Circuit Trek?

The difficulty level for the Manaslu Circuit Trek depends on how fit, experienced, and prepared a person is. Generally, it is considered as a moderate-level trek. Trekking can be challenging because of the high altitude, long hours of walking, and possibly dangerous paths. Completing the trek usually takes 14 to 20 days, with an average of 5 to 10 hours of daily walking. The climb up and down the Larkya La pass is particularly challenging, but it offers a breathtaking view of the surrounding peaks. Hiking for more than two weeks might make the trekker feel monotonous.

There are a few factors that make Manaslu Circuit Trek challenging:

- **Altitude:** Manaslu Circuit Trek is at an altitude of **5610m**, which means there is a huge risk of altitude sickness. The chance of altitude sickness increases around 3000m, so the risk of falling ill is high when trekking above the altitude of 4000 to 5000m.

- **Distance and Duration:** Trekking long distances for many days makes the trek challenging. You will soon get tired if you are not physically fit and lack stamina. Being fatigued during the **14-day** Manaslu Circuit trek always led to severe health issues. So be sure to be physically fit by performing exercises months before going on a trek.
- **Rugged Terrains:** The Manaslu Circuit Trek is not easy regarding terrain and trails. The terrain changes constantly during this trek. In the lower altitudes, you will pass through tropical jungles and vast grasslands; as you pass through, you will come across valleys and snow-capped mountains.
- **Remote location and limited access:** The Manaslu circuit trek lies in one of the most remote regions in Nepal. The infrastructure in this region is minimal. You will be deprived of facilities such as quality accommodation, medical aid, and a better communication network.
- **Weather and Temperature Variations:** The weather in the Himalayas is unpredictable. The temperature changes in no time. It might rain, receive a snowfall, or the weather might turn chilly. Temperature and weather unpredictability make this Manaslu Circuit Trek one of the most challenging treks.

Accommodation Available at Manaslu Circuit Trek

The Manaslu Circuit Trek offers several accommodations, from simple teahouses to more comfortable ones, ranging from basic to mid-range options. However, luxury accommodations are rare due to the remote location. Tea houses are common and budget options on the trek, especially at the higher locations. They provide basic yet comfortable accommodation facilities. Dormitory-style or twin-sharing rooms with thin mattresses, pillows, and blankets are sleeping arrangements that the tea houses offer. Toilets are generally shared bases, mostly squat-style and outside the room.

Furthermore, mid-range tea houses are slightly more comfortable and offer better services and facilities than budget ones. These options are common at Maccha Kholam Smagoan and Deng. The accommodation option offers a twin-sharing room with a thicker mattress and warm blanket. The toilet facilities are a mix of Western-style squats and shared indoors. Likewise, it also offers cozy dining rooms.

Breakfast, Lunch, and Dinner During Our Manaslu Trek

Throughout your Manaslu Circuit Trek, Nepal Alternative Trek provides you with three times meals a day: breakfast, lunch, and dinner in local tea houses or guest houses. The tea houses offer a mix of traditional local cuisine and some international dishes. Dal Bhat, Dhido, Gundruk, and local bread are some popular traditional Nepali food and tea houses along the trail to Manaslu trek. Likewise, Pasta, momo, noodles, rice and curry, and soup are other common meals. Moreover, some breakfast options include porridge, Tibetan bread, boiled egg, tea, and coffee.

Besides consuming proper nutrition through meals, trekkers should equally stay properly hydrated throughout the journey to Manaslu. We recommend trekkers carry a refillable water bottle, as water sources are available along the trail. Yet, consuming water directly from natural sources is not recommended, as that may cause water-borne diseases. Thus, consider carrying a water purification tablet to stay hydrated safely.

Routes of Manaslu Circuit Trek

Manaslu Circuit Trek begins in Kathmandu, and you drive west from the capital to Arughat. Following the Budhi Gandaki River north, the road trip continues to Machha Khola, where the trek officially begins. The trail takes you through several Magar villages before you stop at Deng. As you continue in the company of Nubri ethnic people, the trail will head west and take you to Namrung. Then, the next trek takes you to Sama Gaon, where you can rest for an extra day and explore. On this day, you can head to the Manaslu Base Camp and soak in the views of Mt. Manaslu (8163m). While exploring, you can also head to the Birendra Lake or Pung Gyen Gompa.

After completing the detour to the base camp, you head north towards Dharamshala. Further, the altitude increases to 5160 meters at the top of Larkya La Pass. The top grants surreal sights of the vistas in Manaslu, Annapurna, and Cheo Himal ranges. Then, the descent from the pass will take you to Bimthang. Finally, the trek heads to Dharapani and continues across the Marsyangdi River to reach Besisahar.

Manaslu Circuit Trek Length And Terrain

The total distance to be covered during this Manaslu Circuit Trek is around **180** km. It is one of the longest off-the-beaten paths to trek in. Despite being a moderate-level trek, there are certain challenging ascents and descents in this trek. You will need to walk for around **6-8** hours per day. Generally, you must cover around **10-15** Kms per day. However, the total hiking distance in a day depends on factors like the ascents to be undertaken, the distance to be covered, etc.

Trekking on this long route will allow you to encounter several endangered animals in this region. The trek's highest point is at Larkya La Pass, 5135 meters from sea level. The pass might be slippery at times and is one of the most challenging ascents in this trek. The trails are narrow, so you must carefully sit on the side if you pass through a Yaks.

A Typical Day On Manaslu Circuit Trek

A typical blend on Manaslu Circuit is a blend of physical exertion, cultural immersion, and awe-inspiring natural beauty. Trekkers usually wake up around 6:00 am to take advantage of the daylight. The crisp mountain air energizes them for the day ahead. The trek begins early, around 7:00 am, after breakfast. Daily, trekkers should walk for 6-7 hours, depending on the duration and trekker's pace. Each day, the trek passes through stunning villages of Manaslu Circuit, including Jagat, Deng, Namrung, Lho Gaon, Sama Gaon, Dharamshala, Bimthang, and Dharapani. The trail involves a mix of ascents, descents, and flat sections.

Around noon, trekkers stop at a teahouse or scenic point for lunch. Dal Bhat, noodles, or soup are the common options for lunch, providing the energy needed for the afternoon hike. The trek continues after lunch, and depending on the day's itinerary, trekkers cross suspension bridges, trek through lush forests, or encounter mani walls and prayer wheels. Trekkers usually get to the day's destination by 4:00 to 5:00 pm. Dinner is served at the tea house, where they'll stay between 6:00 and 7:00 pm, with options including momo, pasta, and Dal Bhat. Bedtimes come early, around 8:30 to 9:00 pm, to ensure enough rest for the next day.

Furthermore, the view of Mount Manaslu, Larkya La Pass, Budhi Gandaki River with cascading

waterfalls, glaciers and icefalls, and traditional villages are scenic highlights of the Manaslu Circuit trek.

Where is Mt. Manaslu Located?

Mt. Manaslu is 8163m above sea level and is located in the western central part of Nepal, in the Mansiri part of the Nepalese Himalayas. The name Manaslu comes from the word “mountain of the spirit.” It is situated on Mount Annapurna’s eastern side and about 64km apart.

Mount Manaslu is the highest peak in the Gorkha district. The stunning peaks and valleys tower around the region, making the surrounding valley look majestic when you climb the ridge leading towards the peak.

Mount Manaslu was first climbed by dual mountain climbers Gyalzen Norbu and Toshio Imanishi on May 9, 1956. At that time, they were part of an exceptional, highly professional Japanese expedition team. Many historians have claimed that Janpaese mountain climbers love climbing Mount Manaslu even more than British people who love climbing Mount Everest.

Best Time for Manaslu Circuit Trek

The best time for the Manaslu Circuit Trek is the Spring and Autumn. These seasons offer the ideal conditions for trekking in the Himalayas. The temperature is moderate and is suitable for hiking in the Himalayas. The seasonal overview for the Manaslu Circuit is described below.

Spring Season

One of the best times for trekking the Manaslu Circuit Trek is the Spring season. The spring season in Nepal lasts from March to May. As the winter season ends, Spring begins. Early spring months are still chilly, but as the days pass, the temperature gets cooler, and the weather is very clear. Temperature during the time ranges from

10°C to 20°C in the daytime and 5°C at nighttime in the lower region and -2°C to 5°C during day at lower elevation and -10°C to -5°C at night in higher elevation.

Another stunning part of trekking in the Spring season is the blooming rhododendron forests along the trails. Due to the exceptional trekking conditions, the major problem in trekking in the spring season is the overcrowding of trails and tea houses. Furthermore, due to more demand, the cost of trek also increases.

Autumn Season

Another best trekking season for the Manaslu Circuit Trek is autumn. The autumn season in Nepal starts in September and lasts until November. Autumn starts in Nepal right after the summer/monsoon season ends. For the first few weeks, you will be getting some rainfall in the lower altitudes of the region. Temperature in AUtumn ranges from 0°C to 20°C during the day in the lower regions and -5°C to 10°C in the higher regions. At night, temperatures drop significantly, especially at higher altitudes, ranging from -10°C to -5°C.

October is the peak Autumn season in Nepal when the weather gets beautiful, and the temperature is ideal for trekking. The views of the skies and mountains are also very clear, making it an amazing season

to click on some majestic photos.

Off-Season Trekking

The least two ideal times for trekking in the Manaslu region are either monsoon or winter. The winter season brings immense cold, harsh temperatures, and dynamic weather. The weather changes quickly from hot, sunny days to blistering winds to cold, snowy nights. During winter, the temperature of the Manaslu Circuit falls well below the freezing point. During the season, temperatures range from 5°C to 15°C in the daytime and can drop to -5°C at lower elevations. Likewise, Daytime temperatures range from -10°C to 5°C, and nighttime drops to -20°C or low at higher action.

On the other hand, during monsoon season, rainfall is relentless at lower altitudes. Constant mild to heavy rainfall makes trekking trails wet, slippery, and full of insects and leeches. Nepal has a higher chance of floods and landslides during monsoon season, so be careful if you are even considering trekking now. Yet, trekkers are pleasant during the time, ranging from 15°C to 25°C during the day and 5°C to 10°C at night, even at higher altitudes.

Off-season trekking for the Manaslu Circuit.

The Manaslu Circuit Trek during the **off-season** will present you with certain challenges. Summer and Winter are generally considered the off-season for the Manaslu Circuit Trek. The weather conditions are not ideal for trekking during these seasons. The monsoon in Nepal falls under the summer season. Heavy rainfall in the lower parts of the Manaslu circuit will make it challenging to trek in the Himalayas. The weather can't be predicted during the monsoon months. It may rain in no time, or the weather might turn chilly. However, the temperature is moderate during this time and is best for trekking in this region.

Unlike Summer, the Manaslu region receives heavy rainfall during the Winter months. The trails get covered with snow, making it highly challenging to trek. Moreover, the temperature drops below freezing point. Crossing the trek's highest point, Larkya La Pass, might require mountaineering tools like crampons. Trekking to the Manaslu Circuit during the winter season will be one of the most challenging adventures you will ever be on.

Fitness and Experience requirements

You must be physically fit for the Manaslu Circuit Treks; however, you don't need any major experience in mountain or peak climbing. You can participate in training exercises that help you build your physical fitness.

Some methods for the improvement in physical fitness are:

- Strength Training
- Cardiovascular Training
- Simple Hiking Training

Is Travel Insurance Required for Manaslu Trek

If you plan to go on the Manaslu Circuit Trek, which reaches an altitude of 5610 meters, you should be

aware of the risk of altitude sickness. To avoid costly helicopter rescues, get travel insurance covering extreme adventures and submit it to your trekking agency. This will help ensure a smoother process.

Can Beginner Trek to Manaslu Circuit?

Yes, beginners can trek the Manaslu Circuit. You don't need trekking experience or training to climb mountains.

However, you shouldn't mistake it for an easy trek. It falls under moderate-level trekking for even veteran trekkers. This means that for beginners, this trek will undoubtedly be quite challenging. Certain factors increase the difficulty level during your trek. These factors affect beginner trekkers more adversely than the expert veterans who have been trekking for days.

The factors are Altitude, Best Time, Acclimatization, Drinking Water, Physical Fitness, etc. Understanding these basic factors before heading for the Manaslu Circuit Trek will make the trek less challenging than going there completely blind.

So, preparing for the Manaslu Circuit Trek by improving your physical fitness and spending time on breathing exercises will make your trek less challenging and more fun. Also, acclimatize as much as you can and listen to your body. Don't forget to take medication for altitude sickness if you are a beginner in case of emergencies.

Alternative to Manaslu Circuit Trek

Two excellent options, the Tsum Valley Trek and the Annapurna Circuit Trek, stand out as alternatives to the Manaslu Circuit Trek. Both treks showcase Nepal's stunning natural topography, cultural variety, and thrilling adventure opportunities.

Tsum Valley Trek in the Manaslu region in northern Gorkha is a compelling voyage through a remote area of Nepal that is rich in ancient art, culture, and religion. Known as the "Hidden Valley," it is quieter and more secluded. The region lies in a restricted area and requires a special RAP (Restricted Area Permit). Mu Gompa and Rachen Gompa are the prominent cultural heritage of the Valley. The trek takes 14-16 days to complete and offers the scenic beauty of Ganesh Himal and Sringi Himal.

Annapurna Base Camp, a globally renowned trekking route in the Annapurna region of Nepal, is the finest destination and an alternative to the Manaslu Circuit Trek. The trek offers a blend of varied landscapes, cultural immersion, and adventure to high-altitude locations. It generally takes 12-21 days to complete, and Thorong La Pass, at 5,416m, is the highest point of the trek.

Transportation for Manaslu Circuit Trek

Public buses and private jeeps are common transportation options for Manaslu Circuit Trek. Trekkers should drive either by public bus or jeep from Kathmandu to Macchakhola and Macchakhola to Kathmandu. Kathmandu to Macchakhola is 160 kilometers /99 miles, taking 9 to 10 hours by public bus and 7 to 8 hours by jeep. Both options offer amazing transformation of Nepal's countryside and stunning scenery along the way. Moreover, the road is a mix of paved and unpaved sections; Kathmandu to Dhading Besi is well-paved, and onwards to Dhading, the road is bumpy and gravel.

Public Bus

Morning buses from Kathmandu to Maccha Khola are operated daily from Kathmandu's bus park. They are 35-seater buses that take 9-10 hours to reach the destination. A private bus ticket costs between \$10-12, which is one of the budget-friendly options. Moreover, the bus stops for lunch and toilet breaks one to two times along the way.

Private Jeep

Private Jeeps to Macchakhola from Kathmandu are another popular and comfortable option. They offer a more flexible and comfortable way to get to the destination, with better seating and space than public buses. Also, they are faster, taking 7-8 hours, and can stop at the preferred area. The private jeep from Kathmandu to Macchakhola costs USD 250, and if you prefer to join a shared jeep, it costs USD 15 per pax.

Communication & Electricity Facilities

The trek to Manaslu Circuit is remote and adventurous; despite its isolation, trekkers can access essential communication and electricity facilities at various points along the route. Nepal Telecom (NTC) and Ncell are mobile network coverage accessible on the journey. In the lower regions like Soti Khola, Maccha Khola, and Jagat, network coverage is good but unavailable in higher altitudes like Samagaon and Dharmasala. Likewise, internet services are available in most tea houses through Wifi but at an additional cost, which can still be slow and unreliable at higher elevations.

Furthermore, electricity is available along the trek, but facilities and reliability depend on the altitude and remoteness of the village. At the lower elevation, villages are connected to the national electricity grid, and power is supplied regularly with minimal interruptions. At the higher elevation, electricity is primarily sourced from solar panels, and supply can be limited. The charging facilities for electronic devices are also available but at an additional cost. Bringing a power bank, buying a local SIM card, using offline maps, and carrying a solar charger are some tips for managing communication and electricity.

How to Train For Manaslu Circuit Trek

Manaslu Circuit is a challenging trek in Nepal's Himalayas, so training is crucial before starting the trek. Here's how you can prepare effectively for the trek:

Physical exercise

Physical fitness is foremost for trekking in the Manaslu Circuit as it helps build strength, which is crucial for steep ascents, descents, and long trekking days. To be physically fit, engage in leg-strengthening exercises, including squats, lunges, and set-ups. Also, include core training like planks, crunches, and other exercises to stabilize your body while carrying a backpack. Moreover, engage in exercise that makes your body flexible.

Acclimatize Properly

Acclimatization is key to completing the trek to Manaslu Circuit successfully and avoiding the risk of altitude sickness. Altitude sickness is a significant problem as trekkers move above 2,500m, and the Manaslu Circuit trek takes trekkers up to an elevation of 5,106m, where the risk of altitude-related issues is high. Thus, proper acclimatization is the only way to minimize the risk. To be properly acclimatized, ascent gradually, spend time at higher elevations, and stay hydrated throughout the trek.

Cardiovascular exercises

The trek involves long hours of walking at high altitudes, so cardiovascular exercise is essential. Exercise includes regular hikes on uneven terrain, running and jogging to build stamina, and cycling to strengthen your legs and improve endurance.

Mental preparation

The trek not only requires physical fitness but also mental preparedness. Only physical fitness can't help you to achieve your goal until you are mentally fit. To be mentally prepared, engage in yoga, meditation, or breathing exercises. Likewise, stay positive by visualizing your success. Moreover, be ready to walk in a remote location with basic amenities.

Manaslu Circuit Trekking Altitude and Duration

The duration of the Manaslu Circuit Trek varies depending on the chosen itinerary, the need for an acclimatization day, and whether any side trips are added. However, it generally takes 12 - 14 days to complete. Moreover, the duration/ length of the Manaslu Circuit trek is 180km (110 miles) through the varied landscape of dense forests, alpine pastures, and deep gorges.

The Manaslu Circuit trek starts at the lower elevation of Maccha Khola at 690m. Then, the trek gradually ascends. From Macche Khola, the trail moves towards Jagat at 1410m. From Jagat, the altitude rises as it reaches Namrung (2660m). The altitude continues to increase as it ascends through Lho Gaon (3100m), Sama Gaon (3530m), Samdo (3780m), and Dharamshala (4200m). Passing through those villages, the journey reaches the highest elevation, 5,106m, at Larkya La Pass (5160m). From there, the trail descends via Bhimthang (3,590m) and Dharapani (1992m).

Manaslu Circuit Trek Solo Vs. Guided

Solo trekking involves traveling independently without joining a group or hiring a guide. However, due to being a restricted area, trekking solo in Manaslu is not permitted. A strict regulation while trekking in Manaslu states that hiring a licensed guide is mandatory. So, solo trekking in this region usually means trekking without a group but with a guide. In contrast, guided trekking involves joining a group with a professional guide that helps to plan and lead your trek. Due to the remote location and restricted access, guided trekking is most common on this trek. However, each option has its advantages and disadvantages.

Here are some comparison points for the Manaslu Circuit trek solo vs. guided:

Aspect	Solo Trekking	Vs	Guided Trekking
Flexibility	Full control over pace and itinerary.		Limited as a trekker should follow the prearranged itinerary.
Companionship	Usually limited to your guide.		Opportunities to connect with fellow trekkers
Customization	High; itinerary can be adjusted during the trek.		Low; the fixed schedule may restrict changes.
Permits and logistics	You must arrange it yourself (guide assists).		Entirely handled by a guide or trekking agency.
Accommodation choices	Freedom to choose teahouses en route.		Pre-booked accommodations are arranged by the guide.
Equipment and supplies	Must pack and prepare independently.		Guide or travel company provide guidance on necessary gear.

Manaslu Circuit Trek Packing List

While trekking any destination, packing essential gear and equipment is foremost, including for the Manaslu Circuit trek. Proper packing ensures a safe and enjoyable trek. Here is a list of some crucial packing lists for the Manaslu Circuit trek:

Head Wear

- Buff/Neck Gaiter
- Warm hat

Bodywear

- Base layer
- Trekking shirts
- Fleece or down jacket
- Waterproof and windproof jacket
- Trekking pants
- Gloves

Footwear

- Trekking boots
- Hiking socks
- Gaiters (optional)

Sun Protection

- Sunglasses
- Sunscreen
- Sunhat

Backpacks

- Backpack
- Duffle Bag
- Daypack

Other Accessories

- Trekking pole
- Sleeping bag
- Headlamp
- Refillable water bottle
- Water purification tablet
- Quick-Drying towel
- Biodegradable soap and shampoo
- Toiletries and personal accessories
- Lip balm with SPF

Health and Safety

- First aid kit
- Personal medications

Why Book With Us

What do you want in any trekking company you are going to trek with? Probably, it should provide you with customizable itinerary plans, offer last-minute booking, provide 24/7 safety and security, have a highly experienced team, including a guide and porter, focus on environmental and sustainable practices, and, most importantly, value your money. Well, Nepal Alternative Trek possesses each of these qualities.

Customizable itinerary

We want to match each client's preferences; thus, we offer a customizable itinerary facility. Whether trekkers want a shorter trek or extra days in Nepal's Himalayas, we are always ready to adjust the plan and suit their preferences. This flexibility ensures trekkers get a personalized experience, making the journey unique and remarkable.

Last-minute Booking

Nepal Alternative Treks understands that travel plans are sometimes sudden. Thus, we offer last-minute booking options without compromising quality. We manage everything quickly, whether it is about permits or logistics. We have an extensive network of guides, porters, and local contacts to ensure no delays but fast and reliable service even at the last moment. We make sure that your last-minute decision can also be a lifetime memory.

Value for Money

We believe that earning each penny is not easy and does not come for free, so we make sure your money is valued well with us. Trekking with us means investing in high-quality service at a fair price, with

excellent service and no hidden costs. We offer competitive packages that include essential services along with ensuring a comfortable stay in quality accommodation with delicious meals.

Safety and Security

Clinet's safety is Nepal Alternative Trek's top priority. From hiring an experienced guide to porters with years of experience in the Himalayas, we ensure you have a support team that will be there for you at any cost. Our team monitors your health and ensures your safety throughout the journey. Our guides are trained in first aid, altitude sickness management, and emergency response. With us, you can focus on your trek, knowing a reliable team is looking out for you every step.

Experienced Guides & Porter Service

Our highly skilled and experienced guides are our pride. The guides are licensed professionals with years of experience. They know the trails, local culture, and traditions. Similarly, our porters are well-trained and carry your backpacks, allowing you to trek comfortably. So, be sure that trekking with Nepal Alternative Trek means you're accompanied by knowledgeable and trustable companions.

Environmental and Social Responsibility

Our other specialty is we are committed to protecting the environment and supporting locals. We follow sustainable trekking practices and encourage trekkers to minimize plastic use to promote eco-friendly tourism. Similarly, when you book with us, you are contributing to preserving nature and improving the lives of local individuals indirectly.

Frequently Asked Questions

How long is the Manaslu Circuit trek?

The Manaslu Circuit Trek is about 177 kilometers long. It usually takes around 14 to 18 days to complete, depending on your pace and the time you spend acclimatizing. The trek takes you through beautiful mountain scenery, remote villages, and over the high Larkya La Pass.

Is Manaslu harder than Annapurna?

Yes, the Manaslu Circuit Trek is generally considered harder than the Annapurna Circuit. Manaslu is more remote, with fewer facilities, and the trails are often steeper and more rugged. The Larkya La Pass on the Manaslu trek is also higher and more challenging than the highest point on the Annapurna Circuit.

Do you need oxygen to climb Manaslu?

You generally don't need oxygen to climb Manaslu during the Circuit Trek, as the highest point is the Larkya La Pass at 5,106 meters. However, if you're attempting to summit the Manaslu mountain itself, which is over 8,000 meters, supplemental oxygen is often necessary due to the extreme altitude and

lower oxygen levels.

Do you need a guide for Manaslu Circuit trek?

Yes, you need a guide for the Manaslu Circuit Trek. The government of Nepal requires trekkers to have a licensed guide because the area is remote and less developed. A guide helps navigate the trails, arrange permits, and ensure your safety, especially in high-altitude areas.

How do you prepare for Manaslu trek?

To prepare for the Manaslu trek, you should focus on building your fitness and stamina by doing regular hiking, walking, or cardio exercises for several weeks before the trek. Acclimatization to high altitude is important, so plan to spend time at higher elevations during the trek.

Is Manaslu Circuit trek safe?

The Manaslu Circuit Trek is generally considered safe, but it can be challenging because of its remote location, high altitude, and rugged terrain. It's important to go with a guide, as the trails can be difficult to navigate, especially in bad weather. You'll also need to be prepared for basic conditions, as the area is less developed than other popular trekking regions in Nepal.

What are some fun facts about Mount Manaslu?

Mount Manaslu, the eighth-highest mountain in the world, stands at 8,163 meters. Mount Manaslu is known as the "Mountain of the Spirit," in the Nepalese Himalayas. It is a part of the Manaslu Conservation Area, which is rich in biodiversity.

What is the highest point of Manaslu Circuit trek?

The highest point of the Manaslu Circuit Trek is the Larkya La Pass, which stands at 5,106 meters above sea level. Crossing Larkya La Pass is the most challenging part of the trek, which offers stunning views of snow-capped mountains. Because of the high altitude, it's important to be well-acclimatized before reaching this point.

Why is Manaslu so popular?

Manaslu is popular because it offers stunning views of one of the world's tallest mountains and a chance to experience remote, beautiful landscapes. The trek around Manaslu is less crowded than other famous routes, so you can enjoy nature more peacefully.

How many miles is the Manaslu Circuit trek?

The Manaslu Circuit Trek is about 130 miles long. It usually takes around 14 to 18 days to complete, depending on your pace and how many side trips you take. The trek covers various terrains, from lush valleys to high mountain passes.

How much does the Manaslu Circuit cost?

The cost of the Manaslu Circuit Trek can vary, but it typically ranges from \$1,500 to \$2,500 per person. This price usually includes permits, a guide, and accommodation, but not international flights or personal expenses. Cost can also depend on the trek's duration, the accommodation type, and whether you join a group or have a private guide.

How many people have summited Manaslu?

As of now, 2,400+ climbers have successfully reached the summit of Manaslu. Mount Manaslu has become a popular peak for experienced climbers, though it's still challenging. The number of summits continues to grow as more climbers attempt it each year.

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